Francisca Castro

Contact Information

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Research Interests

Protests, social movements, state repression, intra-state conflict, political violence, causal inference

Positions

Universidad Carlos III de Madrid, Spain
Visiting Professor — 2026 - Current

Institute for Latin American Studies, Freie Universität Berlin, Germany
Affiliated Researcher — 2026 - Current

International Security & Development Center, Germany
Postdoctoral Researcher — 2024 - 2025

Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin, Germany
Doctoral Fellow — 2020 - 2024

Education

Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin, Berlin Graduate School of Social Sciences (BGSS)
Ph.D. Political Science (Dr. phil., *summa cum laude*) — 2025
Committee Members: Anselm Hager (Chair), Vera Tröger, Hanna Schwander

Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile, Santiago, Chile
M.A. Sociology — 2017
B.A. Sociology — 2015
B.A. Political Science — 2014

University of California, Los Angeles
Academic Exchange — 2012

Peer-reviewed articles

8. **Castro. F.** 2026. Guerrilla Shadows on Gender: The Lingering Effects of Peru's Internal Armed Conflict on Women's Political Inclusion. Conditionally accepted in *Conflict Management and Peace Science*.

7. **Castro, F.**2026. Do memory sites influence far-right vote? Evidence from Chile. Accepted for publication in *Research & Politics*.

6. Acevedo, J. & **Castro, F.** 2026. The Mobilizing Potential of Mass Migration: Experimental Evidence from Honduras. *The Journal of Politics*. `https://doi.org/10.1086/742109`.

5. Shoshan, A., Oser, J. & **Castro, F.** 2026. Social movements and social media: The evolution of scholarship in the age of datafication. *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*, 13. `https://doi.org/10.1057/s41599-026-07128-9`

4. **Castro, F.**, Oser, J., Feitosa, F. & Grinberg, N. 2026. External Cues and Policy Preferences: Rethinking the Drivers of Policy Positions. *International Journal of Public Opinion and Research*,

38(1). https://doi.org/10.1093/ijpor/edaf066

3. **Castro, F.** 2025. Deterrence or Defiance? How Severity and Selectivity Shape Protest Responses to Repression. *Mobilization*, 30(4). https://doi.org/10.17813/1086-671X-30-4-387

2. **Castro, F.** & Retamal, R. 2024. Does Electoral Behavior Change After a Protest Cycle? Evidence from Chile and Bolivia. *Electoral Studies*, 89 (June). https://doi.org/10.1016/j.electstud.2024.102777

1. Rivera, V. & **Castro, F.** 2021. Between Social Protests and a Global Pandemic: Working Transitions under the Economic Effects of COVID-19. *Social Sciences*, 10(4), p.145.

Working Papers

"An Analytical Framework for Measuring Food System Resilience in Fragile Situations." (with Alessandra Garbero, Elena Serfilippi, Timur Cipa, Tilman Brück and Wolfgang Stojetz). *Revise and Resubmit*

"Pathways of Negotiated Radicalization: Evidence from Hong Kong and Chile" (with Samson Yuen). *Under Review*

Works in Progress

"Fuel Scarcity and Social Mobilization in Bolivia."

"Conflict-Era Victimization and the Geography of Protest in Peru's Presidential Crises" (with María Sosa)

"Countering the Erosion of Trust: Mitigating the Impact of Electoral Fraud Allegations"
- Funded by the Electoral Integrity Project Fellowship

"How do citizens evaluate politicians' responses to social mobilization?" (with Jennifer Oser)
- Partially funded by APSA Women, Gender & Politics Small Research Grant and Erasmus+ Program, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin

"Backlash or Chilling Effect? Attacks on Environmental Activists and Support for Climate Action" (with Winnie Xia)
- Funded by Aarhus University Small Grant

"Abortion Laws and Institutional Trust: Insights from Mexico's Legal Shifts" (with Frida Nilsson)

"Political Participation and Mass-Elite Congruence in Latin America" (with Jesper Lindqvist and Jennifer Oser)

Research Grants

Slicher van Bath de Jong Foundation Fund, 2026, €8,490
Seed funding, Margherita von Brentano Centre for Gender Studies, Free University of Berlin (with Luisa Feline Freier and Maria Böttche), 2026, €5,000
Aarhus University Small Grant (with Winnie Xia), 2025, DDK 38,000
WarEffects Global Fellowship, 2025, €1,500

Awards and Funding

External Funding

Erasmus+ Staff Mobility for Teaching (KA171) to PUC Chile, 2027, €3,825
Fulbright Germany Forschen und Lehren, 2026-27 (Declined)
Politics & Gender Conference Travel Grant, 2025 (Declined)
DAAD Kongressreisenprogramm, 2025 (Declined)
Electoral Integrity Project Junior Fellowship, 2025, CAD $1,000
WCPS Travel Assistance at APSA, 2024, USD $300

Midwest Women's Caucus Graduate Travel Award, 2024 (Declined)
International Studies Association Travel Grant, 2024 (Declined)
APSA Comparative Politics Section Support Grant, 2023, USD $500
APSA Women, Gender & Politics Research Small Research Grants, 2023, USD $1,000
DAAD Kongressreisenprogramm, 2023, €1,863
Travel Grant "Conflict & Change" PhD Workshop, UCL, 2023, £250
Travel Grant "New Challenges to Democracy" Workshop, University of Montreal, 2022, CAD$1,000
Student Sponsorship, Center for Social Conflict and Cohesion Studies, 2017, USD $1,650
LASA Travel Grant, 2017, USD $490
Center for Social Conflict and Cohesion Studies Scholarship, 2016-2017, USD $3,300
Double Major Scholarship, Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile, 2012-2016, USD $27,391
Calbuco Found Scholarship, 2016-2017, USD $13,915
University of Bath Travel Grant, November 2015, USD $1,662
Brown International Advanced Research Institutes (BARI) Scholarship, June 2015, USD $287
Academic Scholarship, Telefónica Chile S.A, 2010, 2014, and 2015, USD $13,696

Internal Funding

Grant for the Purchase of Research Support Tools, UC3M, 2026, €2,000
Women's Fund, Institute of Social Sciences, Humboldt University, 2023, €281
Budget Commission, Institute of Social Sciences, Humboldt University, 2023, €355
Budget Commission, Institute of Social Sciences, Humboldt University, 2022, €1,125
Budget Commission, Institute of Social Sciences, Humboldt University, 2022, €450
Kultur-, Sozial- und Bildungswissenschaftliche Fakultät Funding, Humboldt University, 2021, €417
Women's Fund, Institute of Social Sciences, Humboldt University, 2021, €634
Budget Commission, Institute of Social Sciences, Humboldt University, 2021, €1,550
Kultur-, Sozial- und Bildungswissenschaftliche Fakultät Funding, Humboldt University, 2020, €600
Academic Exchange Scholarship, Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile, 2012, USD $3,085

Academic Training

Summer School for Women* in Political Methodology, Basel, Switzerland
Web Scraping, Text Analysis, Word Embeddings and Images as Data — July, 2023

Dynamics Research Training Group, Berin, Germany
Image Analysis — June, 2023
Advances in Difference-in-Differences Designs — November, 2022

GESIS Leibniz-Institut für Sozialwissenschaften, Cologne, Germany
Advanced Bayesian Statistical Modelling in R and Stan — October, 2022

Hertie School, Berlin, Germany
Introduction to Teaching in Higher Education — March, 2022

University of Essex, UK
Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis — July, 2021
Introduction to Quantitative Text Analysis
Panel Data Analysis For Comparative Research

Research Experience

ERC Starting Grant Project "Participation and Representation in the Digital Age (PRD)". PI: Prof. Jennifer Oser

Research Associate — January, 2026 - Current

Postdoctoral Researcher — September, 2023 - December 2025

Institute of Sociology, Pontificia Universidad Católica, Chile

Research Assistant May - December 2017
FONDECYT Project 1160921 "The moral economy of meritocracy and redistributive preferences"

Institute of Political Science, Pontificia Universidad Católica, Chile

Research Assistant December, 2015 - April, 2016
Project "Public Support for Regional Integration in Latin America"

Research Assistant March, 2013 - March, 2015
FONDECYT Project 1130897 "Web in movement: the students' movement in Chile and the use of the internet"

Technical Staff September, 2014 - October, 2015
FONDECYT Project 11130538 "Opening the Black Box for Territorial Party Contestation: The Impact of Subnational Politics in the Americas"

Coordinator Latin American Public Opinion Project July - December 2014
Millennium Nucleus of Stateness and Democracy in Latin America, Project NS100015

Thesis Student March - December 2013
FONDECYT Project 1130897 "Web in movement: the students' movement in Chile and the use of the internet"

School of Political Science, Universidad Diego Portales, Chile

Technical Staff March - August, 2015
Millennium Nucleus about Critical Citizenship, Polarization of Inequalities, and Institutions: Political Representation of Chile in a Comparative Perspective

Technical Staff August, 2014 - March, 2015
FONDECYT Project 1140101 "Populism, Constitutionalism and the Politics of Representation: Cross-Regional Patterns"

Fieldwork

Argentina (October 2023); Republic of Congo (July 2024); Perú (August 2025); USA (November 2026).

Teaching

Universidad Carlos III de Madrid, Spain
Lecturer, Quantitative Techniques in Political Science 2nd Quarter 2026
Lecturer, Methodology of Political Science 2nd Quarter 2026

Humboldt University, Institute of Social Sciences, Berlin, Germany
Lecturer, Conflict in Latin America: A Century of Turmoil (BA Seminar) Summer 2024
Lecturer, Collective Political Violence (BA Seminar) Summer 2021, 2023
- Nominated for the Prize for Good Teaching 2023, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin

Lecturer, Comparative Politics and International Relations (BA Basic Course) Winter 2020–2024

Hertie School of Government, Berlin, Germany
Laboratory Assistant, Statistics II (MA Level) Summer 2023
Laboratory Assistant, Statistics I (MA Level) Winter 2021, 2023

Universidad de Talca, School of Public Policy and Public Administration, Chile
Teaching Assistant, Methods for Quantitative Research 2017

Pontificia Universidad Católica, Institute of Political Science, Chile

Instructor, Summer School of Mixed Methods	January 2027 (Scheduled)
Teaching Assistant, Politics and Social Movements	2016
Teaching Assistant, Introduction to Political Theory	2013, 2014

Pontificia Universidad Católica, Institute of Sociology, Chile

Teaching Assistant, Sociology of Public Opinion	2017
Teaching Assistant, Gender Studies	2016
Teaching Assistant, Methods for Social Sciences II	2016
Teaching Assistant, Political Sociology	2016
Teaching Assistant, Qualitative Methods	2015
Teaching Assistant, Formation and Development of Modern Society	2014
Teaching Assistant, Formation and Development of Modern Culture	2013, 2014

Supervision

2026 1 MA thesis, 7 BA theses

Conference Presentations

2026 MPSA Annual Meeting (Online); Instituto Juan Linz Inaugural Conference (Madrid, Spain); EPSS Conference (Belfast, Northern Ireland); Madrid Empirical Social Sciences Conference (upcoming).

2025 MPSA Annual Meeting (Online); WIDER Development Conference (Helsinki, Finland); Jan Tinbergen European Peace Science Conference (Barcelona, Spain); EPSA Conference (Madrid, Spain); Fragile Lives Conference (Berlin, Germany); Life in Kyrgyzstan Conference (Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan).

2024 APSA Virtual Research Meeting (Online); MPSA Annual Meeting; EPSA Conference – chair and discussant (Cologne, Germany); APSA Annual Meeting (Philadelphia, USA); Fragile Lives Conference (Berlin, Germany).

2023 6th International Conference on the Political Economy of Democracy and Dictatorship (Münster, Germany); APSA Annual Meeting (Los Angeles, USA); Annual Conference of the Institute for Social Movement and Protest Studies (Berlin, Germany).

2022 APSA Annual Meeting (Montreal, Canada); Elections, Public Opinion and Parties Conference (Newcastle, UK); EPSA Conference (Prague, Czech Republic); MPSA Annual Meeting – chair and discussant (Chicago, USA).

2021 Society for Latin American Studies (SLAS) Annual Conference (Online); MPSA Annual Meeting (Online).

2018 Latin American Studies Association Congress (Barcelona, Spain).

2017 9th Chilean Congress of Sociology (Talca, Chile); Latin American Sociological Association Congress (Montevideo, Uruguay).

Workshops & Invited Talks

2026 Elections & Political Parties in Africa and Latin America (University of Reading); Internal Seminar (CUNEF University); Atlanta Comparative Political Economy Workshop (University of Georgia); Center for Human Rights and Democracy (Georgia State University); Authoritarian Political Systems Group (upcoming in December).

2024 Conceptualization of Protest Camps Logistic (Free University Berlin); Democratic Resilience Workshop, Centre for Elections, Democracy, Accountability and Representation (University of Birmingham); Multi-Data Perspectives on Democracy Workshop (GESIS Leibniz Institute for the Social

Sciences); Identity, Order, and Violence in the Post-Cold War. Open Society University Network (OSUN, invited talk).

2023 Comparative Politics Colloquium (University of Hamburg); Conflict & Change Annual PhD Workshop (University College London); Quantitative Political Economy Workshop (King's College London); Yet They Persist: Democracies in an Age of Autocratization (University of Milan); War Effects: The Micro-Level Effects of Civil Wars on Multiple Dimensions of Women's Empowerment (University of Bergen).

2022 Gender and Political Participation Graduate Working Group (online); Political Behavior Workshop Berlin-Hamburg (Humboldt University); Internal colloquium (WZB); Comparative Politics Colloquium (University of Hamburg).

2021 Internal Colloquium (NTNU, Norway).

2015 Social Movements in Movement: Concepts and Methods for the study of social movements in Latin America (Universidad de La República, Montevideo, Uruguay); Social movements and the state in the context of the 'left turn' in Latin America (University of Bath).

Professional Service

Peer Review: The Journal of Politics; European Journal of Political Research; Political Behavior; British Journal of Political Science; Journal of Elections, Public Opinion & Parties; Electoral Studies; Journal of Peace Research; Party Politics; Representation; Humanities and Social Sciences Communications; Perspectives on Politics; Mobilization; International Journal of Public Opinion Research; Comparative Migration Studies; Asian Journal of Comparative Politics; Government & Opposition; Regional & Federal Studies; World Development.

Memberships: American Political Science Association, Midwest Political Science Association, European Political Science Society, Latin American Studies Association, Women in Conflict Studies, Estudios de Género y Violencia en América Latina (eGAL) Network, Margherita von Brentano Center (FU Berlin), Instituto Juan Linz.

Departmental & University Service

Universidad Carlos III de Madrid
Tutora Académica Internacional — 2026

Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin
Organizer of Empirical Political Science in Progress Colloquium — 2022

Outreach

Interview in the *Deutsche Welle* "Chile y el voto joven: todo es posible en el balotaje."

Additional Information

- Statistical Software: R, Python, Stata
- Other Software: LaTeX, Qualtrics, QuestionPro, NVivo, MaxQDA
- Languages: Spanish (native), English (fluent), German (TELC B1), Korean (basic)
- Citizenships: Chilean, German